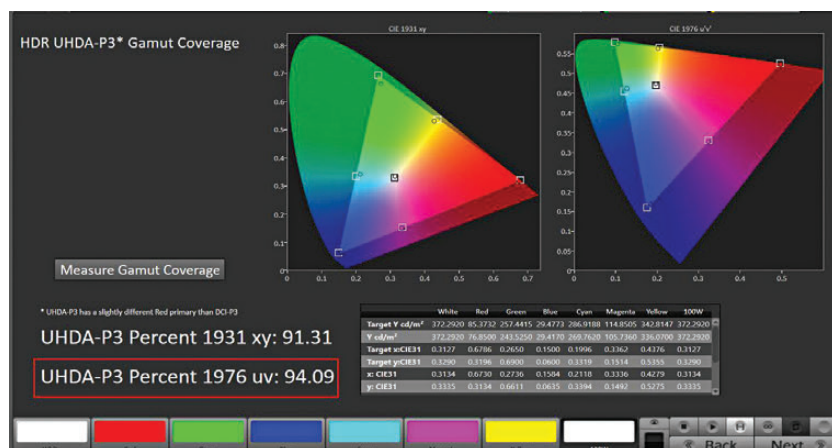




job of upscaling legacy content. Overall, the Bravia 3 offers reliable colour accuracy out of the box in the professional mode and with Dolby Vision HDR. Even modes like Vivid and Standard which perhaps more consumers would use are tastefully boosted without making skin tones and other critical colours look overly unnatural.

PERFORMANCE AND SOFTWARE

Sony Bravia 3 is not particularly snappy but it didn't feel slow either. The playback controls worked reasonably smoothly. We did not notice any unexpected jitters while switching between apps. The XR processor is backed by 16 GB of storage, so that gives a little headroom for performance to stay as is in the long run.

Google TV software is based on Android 12 and Sony has added several useful customizations. The picture customisation options and menu are not as detailed as what you'd get with higher end models starting from Bravia 7. Casting and screen mirroring work seamlessly across Android and iOS devices. The TV supports Apple Airplay, Apple Homekit and Chromecast Built-in. The far-field microphone and voice commands worked well.

GAMING AND AUDIO

For gaming, we tested the Sony Bravia 3 with Sony PS5 and games like Ghost of Tsushima, God of War, Witcher 3 and Spiderman 2. Before you start setting up

your PS5, make sure to switch the HDMI Signal Format to Enhanced format. With PS5 compatibility, we didn't expect that we'd have to do this manually.

The TV supports ALLM and HDR gaming at 4K UHD resolution. High refresh rate and VRR are not supported. PS5 can automatically Adjust HDR parameters like max brightness and optimum dark details based on the Bravia 3 panel and you can further fine-tune the bright and dark levels. The gameplay felt perfectly smooth and the colours also felt accurate.

The Bravia 3 manages pretty decent audio output from its 20W speaker system. Dialogue clarity was above average and we didn't notice much distortion at high volumes. For a capable surround sound experience, you will need to invest in a soundbar.

DESIGN AND BUILD

The Sony Bravia 3 has a familiar Sony design with minimal distractions on the front. The bezels are narrow on three sides, the back of the TV also has a clean look with a checkerboard pattern, and all frequently used connectivity ports are side-facing for convenient access. The TV doesn't ship with a stand in the box. After purchase, you can request a table-top installation for Rs. 2500 or a wall-mount installation for Rs. 1000.

Out of 4 HDMI ports, you can access HDMI 2.1 features on two. One of these is marked eARC output to external sound systems. The remote

is the classic Sony remote and not the eco-remote built from recycled Sorplas plastic - which also makes it relatively sturdier. This is a very ergonomic remote that is comfortable to hold and operate and has all the necessary buttons in the right places.

SHOULD YOU BUY IT?

Sony Bravia 3 is a thoughtfully engineered mid-range TV that delivers impressive colour accuracy, strong SDR performance, and a refined HDR experience. It's clear that Sony has put in considerable effort to maximise the potential of the hardware. During the review, I could appreciate, every now and then, how much serious work has gone into doing justice to the creator's intent and preserving picture quality.

One downside at this price is that peak brightness is not very high, which limits the impact and pop in bright HDR sequences. Performance in dark and mixed APL HDR sequences is still pretty impressive. Solid gaming capabilities further add to its appeal.

Overall, the Bravia 3 offers a balanced experience for those who prioritise accuracy and consistency in their TV viewing experience.

The Bravia 7 is still where my heart is set, but if you can't stretch your budget or find the Bravia 3 at a good deal, it remains a compelling choice in the mid-range segment.

—Deepak Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

Model: K-65530 | Display: 65-inch, Direct LED backlight, Triluminous Pro, Frame Dimming | Panel Type: VA LCD | Display Resolution: 3840 x 2160 - 4K UHD | Panel Refresh Rate: 50Hz | Supported HDR Formats: HDR10, HLG, Dolby Vision | Speakers: 20W | Audio Formats: Dolby Atmos, Dolby Audio | Software: Google TV with Sony customisations (Android TV 12) | Screen Mirroring: Chromecast built-in, Apple AirPlay | HDMI: 4 HDMI ports, ALLM, eARC | Processor: 4K HDR Processor X1 | Storage: 16GB | Other Connectivity Options: 2x USB ports, Dual-band Wi-Fi 6, Bluetooth 5.3, AV, RF, Ethernet, headphone

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